

Spectrea Brand Guide

The complete brand system for Spectrea — a composable knowledge platform that turns scattered information into compounding intelligence.



Tagline: We connect the dots. **Category:** Composable knowledge platform. **Pronunciation:** /spek-
TREE-uh/ (from Latin *spectra* — the full range or spectrum, with a second reading: *revealing*).

Strategic claim: Spectrea is the spectrum of clarity. Everything you know, in one living view — alive with possibility, yours to keep. See it whole. Trust what you see. Build on what you find.

1. Brand Foundation

Why we exist

We live in an information age that's paradoxically making us less informed — more data, less truth; more tools, fewer insights; more noise, less action. Spectrea exists to close the gap between having information, truly understanding it, and being able to build on it.

Mission

To make knowledge trustworthy, connected, and actionable — empowering people to build on what came before, so that every insight becomes the foundation for what comes next.

Vision

A world where anyone can see the full spectrum of what's known, trust what they see, and build on it — where understanding compounds across every boundary that used to contain it.

Positioning

- **For:** Anyone who works with knowledge.
- **Category:** Composable knowledge platform.
- **Promise:** Turns scattered information into compounding intelligence.
- **Tactical:** For anyone who works with knowledge, Spectrea is the composable knowledge platform that turns scattered information into compounding intelligence — unlike fragmented point solutions that silo your knowledge and hide their reasoning.

Messaging hierarchy

Primary theme is **Connection** — the headline “We connect the dots” and the idea that scattered knowledge becomes one living view. Three supporting themes:

1. **Trustworthy Intelligence** — “Intelligence you can trust.” Everything you see is transparent; every action is reviewable.
2. **Compounding Intelligence** — “It gets smarter with every interaction.” Your second year is incomparably better than your first.
3. **Composability** — “Build exactly what you need.” Simple, combinable parts assembled into any solution.

Archetypes — tri-domain split

Spectrea splits its archetype across three surface domains. The voice and emotional register shift with the archetype that owns each surface; the visual aesthetic (spectrum + graph + Warm Blend + modern sans) stays consistent across all three.

Archetype	Owns	The feeling it creates
The Magician	Marketing surfaces (landing pages, launch video, social, blog headers)	The moment of seeing what was hidden. The thrill of pattern emerging from chaos.
The Sage	Trust surfaces (settings, errors, documentation, security pages)	Authority through clarity. The calm of being able to see exactly how something is true.
The Creator	Product surfaces (composition, editor, workflows)	The joy of making. Building something that’s yours.

Personality (four traits with guardrails)

- **Warm** — respects the person behind every interaction. *Guardrail: not soft — trust users to be capable.*
- **Perceptive** — sees patterns others miss; surfaces connections, then steps back. *Guardrail: not presumptuous — suggests, never dictates.*
- **Grounded** — powerful but never pretentious; substance over style. *Guardrail: not boring — substance needs spark.*
- **Adaptive** — meets you where you are; same system, different depths. *Guardrail: not shapeless — Spectrea has a point of view.*

The brand’s *consistency and discipline* — fixed primitives, fixed palette, fixed motion language — is enforced structurally by the system rules in the sections below, not claimed as a personality trait.

Emotional core

Empowerment + Clarity. Feeling more capable because Spectrea helped you see clearly and choose wisely. Like putting on glasses — everything that was blurry snaps into focus.

Visual metaphor

Living Network + Prism. The living network is Spectrea's central visual idea — a web of connections that grows denser and more alive with every interaction. The prism is the etymology echo — what enters as a single stream comes out as the full spectrum, organised and visible. The network is what the brand *feels like*; the prism is where the name *comes from*.

Aesthetic direction

Warm + Intelligent. Like a brilliant mentor — approachable yet deep. Rich colours, inviting spacing, feels human. References: Stripe, Linear (clarity through restraint). Tradeoff: **power over polish** — capability is sacred; elegance is valued but never at the cost of depth.

Values

1. **Human-First** — Spectrea serves people, not the other way around. AI assists understanding; it never replaces judgment.
2. **Trustworthy Intelligence** — everything you see is transparent; every action is reviewable; every connection can be followed back.
3. **Compounding Intelligence** — the more you use it, the more it gives back.
4. **Composable by Nature** — build solutions that fit your world; don't reshape your world to fit a tool.
5. **Accessible Power** — deep capability that meets you where you are. Floor high, ceiling infinite.

Anti-values (what Spectrea never does)

- Never replaces human judgment.
- Never leaves anyone behind.
- Never complex or bloated — if it needs a consultant, we failed.
- Never a black box — you can always ask "why?" and get an answer.

2. Voice & Tone

Voice formula

Clarity of explanation + experiential momentum. Tech earns its place by showing its work.

The formula applies on every surface. Tech doesn't earn its place by impressing or by sleight-of-hand; it earns it by *showing its work* — pointing to the reasoning, the evidence, the source. Confidence comes from being able to see how the answer was reached, not from being told to trust it.

One voice, three archetypes by surface

The voice formula stays the same; the *emotional register* shifts with the archetype that owns each surface:

- **Magician on marketing** — leads with discovery, surprise, the moment of seeing connections that were always there.
- **Sage on trust surfaces** — leads with verification, sources, inspection. Anywhere users go to confirm, review, or understand: settings, errors, audit views, docs, security pages.
- **Creator on product** — leads with agency, composition, building. Anywhere users assemble or shape something of their own.

Tone spectrum

Context	Tone	Example
Marketing copy	Evocative, confident	"Every connection you never noticed. Surfaced."
Product UI	Clear, concise, warm	"3 new connections discovered — review them?"
Error messages	Specific, helpful, never blaming	"This file type isn't supported yet. Try PDF, DOCX, or MD."
Onboarding	Encouraging, low-friction	"Start with one document. The rest will compound."
Technical docs	Precise, well-structured	"The graph grows $O(n \cdot \log n)$ with document count when using the default indexer."

Vocabulary — twelve privileged words

The twelve brand-evocative words that should appear disproportionately often in copy. Each builds the *feeling* of Spectrea — clarity, aliveness, ownership, the act of seeing — without requiring the reader to know what the product does.

Privileged words: spectrum, clarity, whole, see, reveal, illuminate, surface, connect, compose, compound, alive, transparent.

Generic B2B SaaS words (insights, intelligence, transform, empower, unlock, enable, build, evolve, grow, deepen, expand) are still allowed but not privileged — they don't make Spectrea sound like Spectrea. Product-specific words (provenance, traceable, auditable, attributed,

sourced) are also allowed and useful when describing what the product actually does — they just don't do brand voice work.

Words we never use: AI-powered (overused), next-gen, state-of-the-art, world-class, breakthrough, unprecedented, game-changer, revolutionary.

3. Naming

- **Spelling:** Spectrea (capital S, no space).
- **Pronunciation:** /spek-TREE-uh/ — emphasis on the second syllable.
- **Etymology — dual reading:** From *spectra* (Latin: the full range or spectrum). The name does double duty:
 - **Reading 1 — Spectrum:** the full range. The complete view. The whole picture, all in one place.
 - **Reading 2 — Revealing:** bringing what was hidden into clear view. The shift from blur to focus.
 - Together: *the spectrum of clarity* — and the action behind the tagline "We connect the dots."
- **Never:** "SpectreAI", "Spectrea AI" (lead), "spectra" (missing e).

Feature naming convention

Apple-style: Title-case Proper Nouns without brand prefix. Each first-class feature stands on its own; the platform context (Spectrea) is implicit. The convention applies to whatever Spectrea ships, today or in the future.

Pattern	Form
Generic noun (in prose)	lowercase ("the assistant", "the editor")
First-class feature (canonical)	Title-Case Proper Noun ("Assistant", "Editor")
Multi-word feature	Each significant word capitalised ("Spectrum View")
Distinct branded surface	"Spectrea X" — only after deliberate review

Three rules:

1. **Default:** Title-case Proper Noun for first-class features. The capital signals "this is a named thing in Spectrea."
2. **Brand-prefix:** reserved for distinct branded surfaces — separately-paid tiers, developer surfaces, installable companions. Only after deliberate review (a hypothetical *Spectrea Studio* would qualify).

3. **In running prose:** lowercase generic nouns are acceptable when natural ("the assistant suggested"). Canonical name in marketing headers, documentation cross-references, and product UI labels.

4. Logo System



Anatomy

The logo has three parts:

1. **Mark** — the "connecting the dots" S-curve. 10 dots along a cubic Bézier path, with the final three visually trailing. Spectrum-gradient stroke connecting the first seven. The mark also reads as the leading `S` glyph in the lockup.
2. **Wordmark** — Albert Sans Semibold 600, 0.02em letter-spacing. Inside the canonical `Logotype` / `LogotypeGradient` components, the S mark replaces the leading `S` and only the tail `pectrea` is typeset in lowercase — a stylistic treatment, not the typed name. In every other context (manual lockups like the sidebar, descriptor variants, prose, headings, URLs-excepted), use the sentence-case `Spectrea` — the mark sits beside it as a companion glyph rather than a letter substitute.
3. **Lockup** — S mark + lowercase wordmark.

Construction

- **Dots:** 10 dots, radius 3.5. Grey (`#A3A3A3`) in the primary treatment.
- **Stroke:** width 8, round linecap. Cool Duet (Cobalt `#4271DF` → Teal `#00B6A0`) in the static mark and in the gradient lockup's mark.
- **Trailing dots:** the last 3 dots are left visually unconnected — the "about to connect" moment.
- **Container:** 64×64 construction viewBox. Circle container when needed at small sizes; never a squircle.

The two-forms rule (lockup)

The lockup has **exactly two forms** — no third:

1. **Gradient lockup** — `LogotypeGradient` component. S mark carries the two-tone Cool Duet (Cobalt `#4271DF` → Teal `#00B6A0`) on the stroke only; all dots stay grey. The wordmark is monotone — Ink on light, White on dark — following the `colorMode` prop.
2. **Mono lockup** — `Logotype` component. Everything renders in a single `ink` / `white` / `grey` colour.



The gradient lives in the mark only. No gradient-filled wordmark, no full-spectrum lockup — the wordmark is always solid so it stays legible at every size. Duets (Balanced / Warm) belong to the static mark only; they are not lockup options.

Mark colour modes

- `'color'` — full spectrum (Cobalt → Teal → Amber). Default for `AnimatedLogo`. Used for hero moments.
- `'cool'` — Cool Duet (Cobalt → Teal). Default for `StaticLogo`. Primary static mark for everyday use.
- `'balanced'` — Balanced Duet (Teal → `#6FB884` at 65% → Amber). For product/ecosystem moments.
- `'warm'` — Warm Duet (Amber → Rose). For marketing attention.
- `'grey'` — Pewter. Watermarks only.
- `'white'` — Canvas `#FDFDFB`. Dark backgrounds.
- `'ink'` — Ink `#18181C`. Formal, co-branding, single-colour print.

Dot-colour rule

- **Mono mode** (`ink` / `white` / `grey`) → dots match the mark — not grey.

- **Gradient/duet mode** → dots are grey (#A3A3A3). This is the primary brand treatment.
- **Exception:** the intentional "Ink + Grey Dots" variant labelled *Quiet authority* — connection formed, spectrum dormant.

Variants (11 approved)

On light backgrounds:

1. Primary mark (Cool Duet, grey dots)
2. Primary lockup
3. Ink mark
4. Ink lockup
5. Grey mark (watermark only)

On dark backgrounds: 6. Primary on dark (Cool Duet + grey dots) 7. Primary lockup on dark 8. White mark 9. White lockup

Contained (below 48px): 10. Ink circle (white mark on ink fill) 11. White circle (ink mark on white fill)

Lockup arrangements (three)

1. **Gradient logotype** — LogotypeGradient . Preferred for brand/marketing.
2. **Horizontal with descriptor** — StaticLogo + sentence-case Spectrea wordmark + descriptor below. For nav, product headers, sub-brands. Descriptor styling: gap-3 between mark and wordmark column, text-xs , uppercase, tracking-widest, Pewter (#97979E). Because this is a manual composition (not the canonical Logotype component), the mark sits beside the wordmark as a companion glyph — the S is not dropped, and the word is typed Spectrea exactly as in running prose.
3. **Stacked** — mark above wordmark. For title slides, centered compositions. Wordmark width ≤ mark width.

When to use which variant

Context	Variant	Why
Website header (light)	Logotype	Preferred horizontal treatment
Website header (dark)	Logotype (white)	White logotype on dark
Product sidebar / nav	#1 + descriptor	Primary mark with descriptor
Favicon (16–32px)	#10	Ink circle — high contrast small
App icon	#10	Bold, distinctive in app grids
Social avatar	#10	Circular crop on most platforms
Social cover image	#2 or #7	Full lockup, match cover background
Marketing hero	Logotype or stacked	Logotype inline; stacked centered
Co-branding	#3 or #4	Ink prevents colour competition
Legal / formal	#4	Ink lockup — authoritative, max contrast
Watermark	#5 at low opacity	Grey mark, subtle
Emboss / foil stamp	#3	Single-tone production

Clear space

Minimum clear space around the lockup = 0.5× the mark height. No other graphic element (text, border, background image) enters the clear-space box.

Misuse

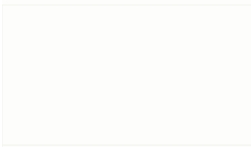
Never: stretch or distort · change colours (spectrum gradient is Cobalt → Teal → Amber; never substitute) · rotate · add drop shadows, glows, bevels · use only the stroke path without dots · use on low-contrast backgrounds (< 2.5:1) · change dot count (always exactly 10) · swap mark and wordmark positions · violate clear space · use a squircle container (always round) · colour the dots in the primary treatment · substitute the wordmark typeface.

5. Colour System

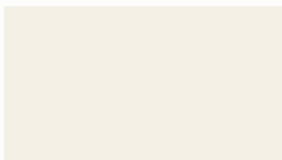
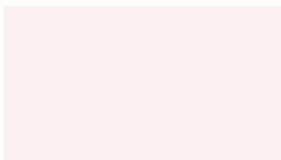
SPECTRUM ACCENTS

			
Cobalt #4271DF	Teal #00B6A0	Amber #E19000	Rose #F24260

WARM BLEND NEUTRALS

				
Canvas #FDFDFB	Cloud #F4F4F1	Pewter #97979E	Graphite #212226	Ink #18181C

BRIDGE TIER (TINTED WASHES)

			
Cobalt Wash #EDF0F8	Teal Mist #E6F5F3	Amber Stone #F5F0E6	Rose Blush #FDF0F2

Spectrum is the brand signature

The four-colour spectrum (Cobalt + Teal + Amber + Rose) is the brand's central visual claim — comparable to how Google's four colours signal Google or Microsoft's four squares signal Microsoft. In **marketing surfaces**, the spectrum is used confidently as the brand's identity: hero gradients, full-spectrum illustration moments, spectrum lockups, the lockup gradient as the signature mark treatment.

In **product UI**, the same four colours stay strictly *semantic* (Tier 3 framework below): Cobalt for action, Teal for success, Amber for attention, Rose for urgency. The discipline doesn't change; only the airtime does. Marketing spends budget on spectrum hero moments; product reserves it for meaning.

Warm Blend neutrals (applied system-wide)

A subtle warm tint layered under the spectrum — closes the gap between cold Tailwind grays and the warm accents. Luminance shift is <2% but cohesive as a system.

Role	Name	Hex	CSS var
Background	Canvas	#FDFDFB	--color-canvas
Elevated surface	Cloud	#F4F4F1	--color-cloud
Muted / secondary text	Pewter	#97979E	--color-pewter
Dark UI surface	Graphite	#212226	--color-graphite
Primary text / dark surface	Ink	#18181C	--color-ink

Spectrum accents (the four spectrum colours)

Role	Name	Hex	Meaning
Hero / primary	Cobalt	#4271DF	Intelligence, trust, focus. One primary action per section.
Positive / growth	Teal	#00B6A0	Success, growth, connected status.
Attention	Amber	#E19000	Warnings, pending, confidence.
Urgency / action	Rose	#F24260	Errors, destructive actions, critical alerts.

Hover/active states for each accent:

- Cobalt: base #4271DF , hover #3A63C4 , active #3255A7 .
- Teal: base #00B6A0 , hover #009E8A , active #008775 .
- Amber: base #E19000 , hover #C58200 , active #A86E00 .
- Rose: base #F24260 , hover #D63B55 , active #BA3249 .

Bridge tier (tinted washes)

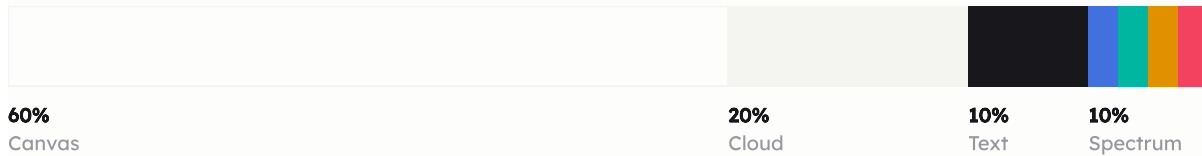
Tiered between the neutral canvas and the vivid accents — 5–10% saturation versions of each spectrum colour. Always carry semantic meaning; never decorative.

Name	Hex	Paired accent	Use
Cobalt Wash	#EDF0F8	Cobalt	Info alert background, selected row
Teal Mist	#E6F5F3	Teal	Success toast, positive trend card
Amber Stone	#F5F0E6	Amber	Warning alert, highlighted callout
Rose Blush	#FDF0F2	Rose	Error message, destructive confirmation

Colour ratio (the 60/20/10/10 rule)

- **60%** Canvas (page background)

- **20%** Cloud (elevated surfaces: cards, sidebars, dropdowns)
- **10%** Ink + Pewter (text and UI)
- **10%** Spectrum accents (semantic moments only)



Tiered colour framework

Every colour in Spectrea lives in one of three tiers:

1. **Tier 1 — Responsive (Cobalt).** Action-oriented elements — things that trigger an operation. Temporary and reactive: present during hover, focus, press, then settles. Primary buttons, links, CTAs, input focus, hovered icons.
2. **Tier 2 — Structural (Ink).** Persistent state and navigation. Active nav item, selected tab, toggled-on icon, current breadcrumb. Ink keeps the canvas calm while Cobalt stays reserved for action.
3. **Tier 3 — Semantic (spectrum + Pewter).** The system communicating status. Info (Cobalt), success (Teal), warning (Amber), error (Rose). Never decorative — every appearance carries meaning.

6. Gradients

Three gradients — don't conflate them.

Primary brand gradient (the default)

Cobalt → **Teal** → **Amber** at 135°, interpolated in **OKLCH** on modern browsers with a clean sRGB fallback. This is the everyday brand gradient — hero sections, accent bars, dividers, decorative strips, progress indicators.



Brand gradient

`linear-gradient(135deg in oklch, #4271DF, #00B6A0, #E19000)` — sRGB fallback

Cross-browser CSS recipe

```
.brand-gradient {
  background: linear-gradient(135deg, #4271DF, #00B6A0, #E19000);
```

```

}
@supports (background: linear-gradient(in oklch, red, blue)) {
  .brand-gradient {
    background: linear-gradient(135deg in oklch, #4271DF, #00B6A0, #E19000);
  }
}

```

The `@supports` block is silently ignored by browsers that don't understand OKLCH (Chrome <111, Safari <16.2, Firefox <117) — they keep the sRGB base. Modern browsers apply the OKLCH override for a perceptually richer middle that avoids the muddy olive zone.

Lockup mark gradient (inside `LogotypeGradient` only)

Two-tone Cool Duet — the same gradient as the primary static mark. The wordmark stays monotone (Ink / White); only the mark carries colour.

0% #4271DF → 100% #00B6A0

Implemented in SVG (`<linearGradient>`). **Never used as a general-purpose decorative gradient.**



Lockup mark gradient — `LogotypeGradient` only, Cool Duet

0% #4271DF → 100% #00B6A0 (wordmark stays monotone Ink / White)

Full spectrum with Rose (sparingly)

Cobalt → Teal → Amber → Rose at 135°. Use only for peak brand expression — landing-page heroes, launch moments. Reserving it keeps its impact.



Full spectrum with Rose — marketing only, use sparingly

#4271DF → #00B6A0 → #E19000 → #F24260

Two-colour duets (adjacent pairs only)

Must use **adjacent** spectrum pairs. Skip pairs (Cobalt → Amber direct, Teal → Rose, Cobalt → Rose) break the continuous-spectrum metaphor and are off-brand.

- **Cool Duet** — Cobalt → Teal. Intelligence + growth. The resting-state duet. Used by the static S mark and data/technical contexts.

- **Balanced Duet** — Teal → #6FB884 at 65% → Amber. *Must* include the #6FB884 intermediate; without it, teal and amber desaturate into muddy olive. For product/ecosystem moments.
- **Warm Duet** — Amber → Rose. Energy + urgency. Marketing, launches, attention.



Cool Duet — intelligence + growth

#4271DF → #00B6A0



Balanced Duet — must include #6FB884 bridge

#00B6A0 → #6FB884 (65%) → #E19000



Warm Duet — energy + urgency

#E19000 → #F24260

Gradient rules

- **Use for:** logo mark background, hero accent bars, marketing page headers, loading progress bars, slide deck title dividers, social media profile accents.
- **Never for:** buttons (use solid Cobalt), text colour, body backgrounds, borders, small icons or badges, repeated elements.

7. Typography

We connect the dots.

ALBERT SANS BOLD 700 · 32px · Display / Hero

Knowledge, connected.

ALBERT SANS SEMIBOLD 600 · 22px · H2 / Section heading

Every document you upload enriches your knowledge graph.

LEXEND REGULAR 400 · 16px · Body

entity.type: "Financial Model" | confidence: 0.94

JETBRAINS MONO REGULAR 400 · 13px · Code / Metadata

Type system (three typefaces)

Role	Family	Weights	Use
Headings	Albert Sans	600 (Semibold), 700 (Bold — logo wordmark, hero only)	Page titles, section headings, card titles, stat values
Body	Lexend	300, 400, 500	Body text, descriptions, form labels, nav items
Code / metadata	JetBrains Mono	400	Inline code, data values, entity types, provenance

Type scale

Display
Heading 1
Heading 2
Heading 3

Body Large — leading paragraphs

Body — default paragraphs

Body SM — secondary text

Caption — labels, timestamps

OVERLINE — SECTION LABELS

code · data values · 0.94

48px · line 1.1

36px · line 1.2

30px · line 1.25

24px · line 1.3

18px · line 1.6

16px · line 1.6

14px · line 1.5

12px · line 1.5

12px · 0.05em tracking

14px · mono

Size	Value	Line height	Weight	Use
Display	48 px	1.1	600	Hero headlines, landing-page titles
H1	36 px	1.2	600	Page titles
H2	30 px	1.25	600	Major section headings
H3	24 px	1.3	600	Sub-section headings, card titles
H4	20 px	1.4	600	Minor headings, dialog titles
H5	18 px	1.4	600	Sidebar section titles
Body LG	18 px	1.6	400	Lead paragraphs
Body	16 px	1.6	400	Default body text
Body SM	14 px	1.5	400	Secondary text, table cells, form inputs
Caption	12 px	1.5	500	Labels, timestamps, helper text
Overline	12 px	1.5	600	Section labels (uppercase + 0.05em tracking)

Responsive scale

Desktop (1024+) / Tablet (640–1023) / Mobile (<640):

- Display: 48 / 36 / 30
- H1: 36 / 30 / 24

- H2: 30 / 24 / 20
- H3: 24 / 20 / 18
- Body / Body SM: unchanged across breakpoints.

Accessibility

- Body text minimum: 16 px. Never lower for primary content.
- Contrast ratio minimum: 4.5:1. Ink on Canvas $\approx$ 17.6:1. Pewter on Canvas $\approx$ 3.1:1 (decorative only).
- Never rely on colour alone — pair colour coding with icons, patterns, or labels.
- Layout must not break at 200% browser text-zoom.

8. Iconography

Library: Tabler Icons (`react-icons/tb` — outline + filled from one library).

Specs:

- Style: outline by default; filled only for active/selected states.
- Stroke width: 2 px (Tabler default, consistent across all icons).
- Stroke caps/joins: round (matches the brand's warm personality).
- Grid: 24×24 px.
- Padding: 2 px inset — content stays within a 20 px live area.

Colour system (tiered):

- **Ink** (`#18181C`) — primary: nav, headings, actions.
- **Pewter** (`#97979E`) — secondary: helpers, disabled, muted.
- **Cobalt** (`#4271DF`) — active state, selected, links (hover responsive).
- **Cloud** (`#F4F4F1`) — on dark backgrounds.

Rule: never use spectrum accents (Teal, Amber, Rose) for decorative icons. Those colours are reserved for semantic meaning.

9. Illustration — v3 system

Spectrea's illustration system is a layered vocabulary plus a four-channel production model. The vocabulary keeps every illustration recognisably one family; the channel model routes each surface to the production approach that can actually deliver it.

Vocabulary — four layers

Layer 1 • Atoms (the brand DNA — the mark itself is built from these). Every illustration must echo at least one.

- **Dot** — filled circle, brand colour
- **Curve** — soft Bézier line connecting things
- **Cluster** — 3–8 dots in proximity, optionally wired with curves
- **Trail** — sequence of 4–6 dots, opacity / size ramping faint → full
- **Field** — soft radial or linear wash in a bridge tone (Cobalt Wash #EDF0F8 · Teal Mist #E6F5F3 · Amber Stone #F5F0E6 · Rose Blush #FDF0F2)

Layer 2 • Forms (geometric shapes for figurative content — co-occur with atoms, never replace them).

- **Rounded rectangle** (body parts, frames, screens, plates)
- **Square** (structural blocks, layout units)
- **Triangle / polygon** (direction, tension, geometric mass)
- **Arc** — 90°–270° circle segment (horizons, archways, partial ranges)
- **Half-circle** (ground, dome, top of a form)
- **Soft blob** (atmospheric mass when not a Field)

Layer 3 • Treatments (how shapes are rendered, applied to both atoms and forms).

- **Filled** (default, primary)
- **Outlined** (ghost / context / negative space)
- **Halo** (soft radial light around a focal element — depth without shadow)
- **Layered** (multiple shapes stacked at varying opacity for depth)

Layer 4 • Palette & ratio. Brand palette only. 60 / 20 / 10 / 10 ratio (Canvas / Cloud / Ink+Pewter / Spectrum). One spectrum hero per composition; supporting colours at lower opacity. Pewter for ghost / context. Paper #FAF8F2 for Editorial Geometry surfaces.

The seven craft moves

Beyond the four layers, these techniques distinguish system-applied-with-craft from shapes-assembled. Every polished illustration uses several:

1. **Arc** — the Bézier's geometric sibling
2. **Halo** — soft radial wash behind a focal Dot or Cluster
3. **Painterly Field** — Field upgraded from flat radial to two-or-more-tone overlapping radials
4. **Spectrum Band** — painterly streak through Cobalt → Teal → Amber → Rose
5. **Translucent Plate** — soft-cornered rectangle at 40–70% opacity in Cloud or Bridge tint
6. **Keyline Rule** — 0.5–1px Pewter hairline (editorial composition skeleton)

7. **Hand-imperfect Mark** — exactly one subtle imperfection per composition (slightly off-round dot, a curve with a tremor)

Plus **paper grain** (SVG noise filter at 4–7% opacity) for Editorial surfaces.

Two paired styles

The brand has two illustration jobs. Pair two styles sharing palette / type / paper ground / curve gesture:

- **Editorial Geometry** — flat geometric shapes on warm paper, Stripe Press / Pelican classics lineage, serif headline + monospace metadata, single warm focal accent. For: homepage hero, About / story, blog headers, press, brand-guide section opens. References: [Stripe Press](#), MIT Press, Fitzcarraldo Editions.
- **Living Graph** — dense node + edge compositions with depth (painterly Fields, halos, layered opacity), atmospheric perspective, focal hierarchy. For: product feature pages, docs hero, “how it works” diagrams, onboarding, in-product loading + empty states. References: [Vercel](#), [Linear](#).

Four production channels

Every illustration is allocated to exactly one channel. No surface gets low-fidelity SVG standing in for what it actually needs.

Channel	Use for	Workflow
In-house SVG (~80%)	Vocabulary cards, layout diagrams, motion demos, dataviz primitives, in-product moments, section dividers, brand mark variants, comparison diagrams, empty/loading states.	Hand-authored SVG, rendered through a verify-and-iterate loop (headless Chrome screenshot → review → iterate).
AI image-gen (~15%)	Marketing heroes, feature page heroes, blog headers, social post imagery, About atmospheric scenes — anything pictorial.	Use the prompt at <code>docs/illustration-prompt.md</code> (v3) → generate via Gemini / DALL-E / Firefly / Stable Diffusion → vectorise with Inkscape (Path → Trace Bitmap) → drop into <code>/public/illustrations/</code> .
Designer commissioned (~5%)	Brand launch keynote, conference banner, print brand-guide cover, About hero, paid-media imagery, photography direction.	Brief the designer with this brand guide. The brand-guide tells them what the system is; the designer produces the heroes.
Canva (optional)	Sales decks, recurring social posts, internal flyers — template-driven recurring formats.	Set up a Spectrea brand kit in Canva (palette, fonts, logo upload). Worth the setup only if used weekly.

Decision rubric

For any new illustration, ask three questions in order:

1. **Is it a system artefact?** Vocabulary card, primitive demo, layout diagram, swatch, in-product moment, dataviz primitive, brand mark variant. → **In-house SVG**.
2. **Does it need a pictorial subject?** A figure mid-action, a scene with depth, a metaphorical landscape, atmospheric texture. → **AI image-gen**.
3. **Does it carry launch / paid media / print?** Homepage hero, conference banner, About hero, print cover, paid campaign. → **Designer**.

Canva is reserved for template-driven recurring formats. If "not sure" — default to in-house, render through the loop, evaluate honestly. If malformed, escalate.

Bauhaus figure specialisation

When an illustration needs to depict people explicitly, use the `SpectreaFigure` component — a Layer-2 Form-layer construct (rounded rectangles for body parts) wrapped in Layer-1 atoms (head Dot, hand Dots, optional idea Trail / Halo). Standing pose only. For scenes needing pose articulation (a person at a desk reaching for a coffee mug, conversation with body language), generate via AI image-gen instead.

What the system never does

- Outlines on filled shapes (outlined is a treatment, applied deliberately — not the default)
- Photorealism, 3D rendering, isometric projection, perspective
- Drop shadows, glows, lens flares (halos replace these)
- Heavy textures, noise, grain, hatching (paper grain at $\leq 7\%$ opacity is the only permitted surface effect)
- Off-brand colours (neon, magenta, cyan, bright yellow, pastel pink, purple, lavender, bright green)
- Mascot characters, anthropomorphic objects, cartoon faces
- Stock photography for warmth — use AI-gen via the prompt

Versioning

v3 (2026-04-18, late) — adds Forms layer, Treatments layer, seven craft moves, paired Editorial Geometry + Living Graph styles, and the four-channel production model. v2 (Dot System with five atoms) is retained as a proper subset of v3 — strict-five-atoms-only compositions are still valid at small scale (vocabulary cards, in-product moments, system diagrams). v3 adds the vocabulary needed to compose larger illustrations without reading as primitive. See `docs/superpowers/specs/2026-04-18-illustration-system-v3-design.md` for the full rationale.

10. Motion

Philosophy

Purposeful, subtle, natural — and alive. Every animation answers "what does this help the user understand?" — if the answer is "nothing," remove it. Most interactive motion stays restrained (150–300ms hovers, focus, state changes). Three signature primitives below carry the brand's "alive, growing, compounding" claim — used purposefully, not decoratively.

Durations

- 100 ms — micro (hover tints, colour shifts)
- 150 ms — standard (UI transitions, dropdowns)
- 200 ms — comfortable (modals, slide-overs)
- 300 ms — deliberate (page transitions, choreographed sequences)

Easing

- `ease-out (cubic-bezier(0, 0, 0.2, 1))` — default for things entering or settling.
- `ease-in-out (cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 0.2, 1))` — for back-and-forth movements, continuous animations.
- Never use linear (feels mechanical) or ease-in alone (feels like something is wrong).

Signature motion primitives (three)

Three brand-distinctive motion patterns. Reusable across any Spectrea surface — used at meaningful moments, not decoratively. Each carries one part of the *alive, growing, compounding* brand claim.

1. Arrival (~400ms). When something important enters the frame — a new card, a fresh result, an inserted item. Spec: scale from 0 with soft elastic settle (`cubic-bezier(0.34, 1.56, 0.64, 1)`), then a brief radial pulse in a brand spectrum colour. Reads as "something just arrived and is alive."

2. Formation (~300ms). When two things visibly connect — a line, a link, a relationship being shown. Spec: a curved stroke draws between two points with the spectrum gradient running along the line (`stroke-dashoffset` animation on an SVG path with a linear gradient stroke), then settles to its resting colour. Echoes the Bézier curve in the brand mark.

3. Spectrum sweep (~600ms). The brand's signature moment — used sparingly when something meaningful happens that deserves the brand's full voice. Spec: a thin gradient strip (4px tall, ~75% width of its container) traverses Cobalt → Teal → Amber → Rose with `background-position` animation across a 4× wide gradient, fading in at 15% and out at 85%. Spectrea's most distinctive motion. Reserve for moments that genuinely matter — overuse dilutes it.

Animated mark

The Spectrea mark animates on a 3-second loop: the spectrum stroke draws along the S curve, pauses, then dissolves to reveal the dots again. Always uses the **full spectrum** (Cobalt → Teal → Amber) — the "reveal" moment. Use for loading states, hero animations, and motion assets.

11. Components

Buttons

- **Primary (Cobalt)** — the hero action. One per section. `#4271DF`, white text; hover `#3A63C4`; active `#3255A7`.
- **Secondary** — supporting actions. Cloud (`#F4F4F1`) background, Ink text (light); Graphite tint background, Cloud text (dark).
- **Ghost** — tertiary actions. 2-px border, transparent background.
- **Destructive (Rose)** — irreversible actions. `#F24260`, white text.
- **Confirm (Teal)** — verify, approve, connect. `#00B6A0`, white text.
- **Caution (Amber)** — override, merge, proceed. `#E19000`, white text.

Common specs: padding `px-4 py-2` (default), radius `8 px` (rounded-lg), font `Lexend 500`, font-size `14 px`.

Focus ring: Amber `rgba(225, 144, 0, 0.7)` (alpha-tinted `#E19000`), 2 px solid, 2 px offset (`.btn-focus:focus-visible`).

Forms

Input fields: `1 px` border (Tailwind `stone-200` ≈ Cloud-adjacent), `8 px` radius, `px-3 py-2` padding, `14 px` Lexend. On focus: `2 px` Cobalt border, no separate shadow ring. Placeholder colour: Pewter.

Cards

Container: `1 px` border (Tailwind `stone-200`), `12 px` radius (rounded-xl), `20 px` padding (p-5), Canvas background. Elevated variant adds `shadow-md` (floating elements only). Cards sit on the Cloud surface — the Canvas-vs-Cloud contrast gives them "home."

Layout

- **Sidebar**: 256 px fixed width, collapsible on mobile.
- **Top bar**: 40–48 px height. Search + user menu.
- **Content area**: fluid, scrollable, Cloud (`#F4F4F1`) background.

- **Breakpoints:** mobile <640 px (1 column), tablet 640–1023 (2 cols), desktop 1024–1279 (3 cols), wide 1280+ (4 cols).
- **Base spacing unit:** 4 px. All spacing values are multiples of 4.

12. Communications

Voice in action

Every piece of written output — product copy, email, social, presentation slides — follows the same voice formula: clear, specific, warm. Technical language is welcomed when it earns its place (“graph architecture” is fine; “leveraging our graph-based RAG pipeline for vector embeddings” is not).

Email

- **Signature:** Logotype at `fontSize=11` , `colorMode="ink"` , `color="#212226"` , followed by “| We connect the dots.”
- **Transactional header:** LogotypeGradient at `fontSize=13` on Canvas.
- **Marketing header (dark):** LogotypeGradient at `fontSize=13` on Ink. No `wordmarkColor` override.
- **Body typography:** Lexend 400, 16 px , Ink on Canvas.

Social media

- **Avatar:** gradient mark at 400×400 px (square, no crop).
- **Cover images:** brand gradient bar + tagline on Ink background (LinkedIn); gradient bar at bottom with tagline centered (Twitter/X).
- **Bio template:** “We connect the dots. Composable knowledge platform.”
- **Quote card:** Ink background, Cloud text, `h-1` brand gradient accent strip at bottom.
- **Stat card:** Ink background, 3 xl Cloud number, Pewter supporting text, gradient accent strip at bottom.

Presentations

- **Canvas slide background:** Canvas (`#FDFDFB`).
- **Ink slide background:** Ink (`#18181C`) — for divider / emphasis slides.
- **Title typography:** Albert Sans 600, 48 px.
- **Body typography:** Lexend 400, 24 px.
- **Accent strip:** brand gradient, 4 px tall, at the bottom of title slides.
- **Footer:** Logotype at `fontSize=9` , `colorMode="ink"` , `color="#97979E"` .

13. Governance

The simple test

If you need to ask "is this OK?" — it probably isn't. The logo should always look exactly like the approved versions on the Variations page. When in doubt, use the primary treatment (grey dots, Cool-Duet stroke) on Canvas — that's always correct.

Change process

1. **Propose** — document what you want to change and why.
2. **Review** — design lead + brand lead sign off.
3. **Version** — bump this guide and the related code.
4. **Communicate** — change log posted in `#brand`.

Owner

Brand lead owns this document. Updates live here; downstream consumers (Figma library, Tailwind config, PDF export) are regenerated from this as source of truth.

14. Resources

CSS tokens

```
:root {
  /* Spectrum */
  --color-brand: #4271DF;
  --color-brand-teal: #00B6A0;
  --color-brand-amber: #E19000;
  --color-brand-rose: #F24260;

  /* Warm Blend neutrals */
  --color-canvas: #FDFDFB;
  --color-cloud: #F4F4F1;
  --color-pewter: #97979E;
  --color-graphite: #212226;
  --color-ink: #18181C;

  /* Typography */
  --font-heading: 'Albert Sans', sans-serif;
  --font-body: 'Lexend', 'Inter', sans-serif;
  --font-mono: 'JetBrains Mono', monospace;
```



```
/* Radii */
--radius-lg: 8px;
--radius-xl: 12px;
}

/* Brand gradient — OKLCH with sRGB fallback */
.brand-gradient {
  background: linear-gradient(135deg, #4271DF, #00B6A0, #E19000);
}
@supports (background: linear-gradient(in oklch, red, blue)) {
  .brand-gradient {
    background: linear-gradient(135deg in oklch, #4271DF, #00B6A0, #E19000);
  }
}
```

Icon library

Tabler Icons via `react-icons/tb` — outline and filled from one library. 2 px stroke, round caps/joins, 24×24 grid.

Fonts

All via Google Fonts:

- [Albert Sans](#) (weights 600, 700)
- [Lexend](#) (weights 300, 400, 500)
- [JetBrains Mono](#) (weight 400)

This document is the single source of truth for the Spectrea brand. The live web version at spectrea.com/brand contains interactive demos and the asset generator. If this document and the web guide ever disagree, this document wins.